

PETO ALBERTALLI

CHAITANYA TAMHANE, 34

Filmmaker

Holding Court

Few directorial debuts have been as thought-provoking as the National Award-winning feature *Court* (2014). That a 27-year-old was the creator of this wry and devastating critique of the Indian judiciary impressed many. "I had a few simple rules in mind: the film's form and tone should be consistent, its craft should have a certain standard and hold up in any part of the world, and that I should grant intelligence and intuition to the viewer," says director Chaitanya Tamhane.

Tamhane deployed the same tactics to profound effect in his second film, *The Disciple* (2020), a Marathi-language drama that follows a classical vocalist high on aspiration but low on talent. Tamhane's films defy the mainstream mould and he doesn't foresee them "ever being truly popular".

"I aspire to be authentic in my work. I want to be truly myself, and then transcend that into my work"

But even with the acclaim and the string of awards, Tamhane is unsure of how long he wants to keep making films. "It requires a lot of stamina, a lot of hustling and a lot of people management," says the director whose two films were independently produced by actor-producer Vivek Gomber. "It's Sisyphean in that you have to fight the same battles over and over again...even now it's still always about what to make next and how to get it made." ■

–Suhani Singh

SOAPY START Tamhane started out as an assistant writer on the Balaji Telefilms show, *Kya Hoga Nimmo Kaa*

EARNING HIS STRIPES

ADARSH GOURAV, 27

Actor

Adarsh Gourav isn't tall and brawny like the conventional Hindi film hero. What he is, is an adept performer with intense eyes and a fascinating screen presence like the late Irrfan. These attributes were on notice earlier this year when he stole the show in the Netflix film, *The White Tiger*. "I was almost not going for the audition," says Gourav. "It was such a big part...I thought they would take someone more recognisable." The actor would go on to win critical acclaim including an Independent Spirit Award nomination for best actor. He hasn't looked back since.



TRISTAN FEWINGS/GETTY IMAGES

NIMISHA SAJAYAN, 24

Actor